Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 10 6
♥ 7
♦ K J 9 6 2
♣ K 6 5

♠ 8 5
♥ A Q 8 5
♦ 5 4 3
♣ Q J 10 2

♠ 9 4 3
♥ 9 6 4
♦ A Q 10 8
♣ 9 8 3

♠ K J 7 2
♥ K J 10 3 2
♦ 7
♣ A 7 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♠3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♠

Lead any ♠.

You have ♦ winners, but dummy will surely be short since he has at least 8 cards in the Major suits.

Partner has whatever ♥ strength your side possesses.

It is very likely that declarer will want to do some cross-trumping. To try to cut that down your best lead is a trump.

Just imagine that declarer wins the first ♠ in his hand and plays a ♥ to dummy's honors. West will win and play another trump. Whenever you win your first ♦ you will play your last trump.

As you can imagine, declarer will be in a whole lot of trouble.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 5 ♥ J 10 4 2 ♦ 9 6 5 4 3 ♣ J 9	
♠ 8 7 2 ♥ K 8 7 ♦ K Q J ♣ A 8 5 4	N W E S	♠ A Q 6 ♥ A Q 9 ♦ A 10 7 ♣ K Q 7 3
	♠ K J 9 4 3 ♥ 6 5 3 ♦ 8 2 ♣ 10 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by East
Lead: ♥6

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

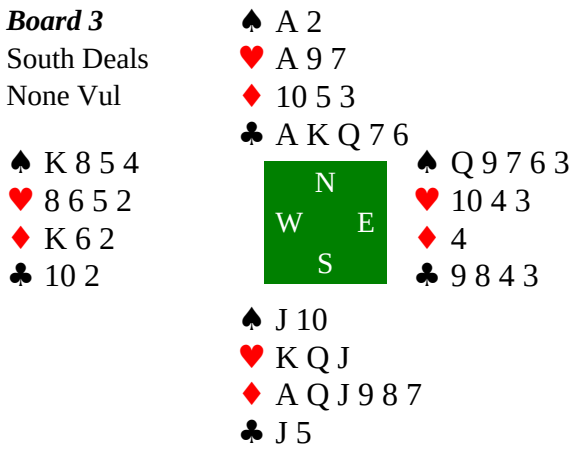
You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the conract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid 4-card Major in either hand.

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	2♣	Pass	3♦
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♦ by South
Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6♦

Lead the ♠4.

Against a notrump slam it is best to make a passive lead so you don't give declarer an undeserved winner.

Against a suit slam the situation is very different. Against strong dummy bidding like this you are pretty sure that if you don't establish a winner early declarer will find something in dummy to discard losers on. In this hand it is dummy's ♣ suit.

Your most promising suit is ♠s. Obviously partner has a very weak hand, but if he has the ♠Q you can set up your ♠K before your King of trumps is dislodged.

Without a ♠ lead declarer will have smooth sailing.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ Q J 10 8
♥ Q 10 5 4 2
♦ 7 3
♣ A 3

♠ A 4 3
♥ A 9 8
♦ A J 10 6
♣ Q 10 4

♠ 9 7 5
♥ J 7
♦ K Q 8
♣ K J 9 8 2

♠ K 6 2
♥ K 6 3
♦ 9 5 4 2
♣ 7 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♥4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥4.

This is a close call. The top of your ♠ honor sequence is very tempting, but even when you find partner with the ♠K you can still only establish three ♠ winners to go with your ♣A. Unfortunately, that's not enough to defeat the contract.

Leading a ♥ from your 5-card suit is riskier, but it has the potential of setting up an additional winner. In this hand, as you see, the ♥ lead gets you 4 ♥ winners to go with your ♣A.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 9 3 ♥ Q J 7 4 3 ♦ K ♣ K 8 7 4	
♠ Q 10 6 2 ♥ 10 ♦ Q J 9 6 ♣ Q 10 9 3		♠ 8 4 ♥ 9 8 2 ♦ A 10 5 3 ♣ A J 6 2
	♠ K J 7 5 ♥ A K 6 5 ♦ 8 7 4 2 ♣ 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♣	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♥9

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♥

Underleading an Ace against a suit contract is the absolute worst opening lead in Bridge. A careful look at this hand shows just how bad it can turn out.

And leading from a doubleton in a suit the opponents have bid is almost as bad.

So by process of elimination you lead a trump, probably the ♥9.

And when North plays ♣s, (preparing to ruff in dummy), you will win and play another trump. Even if North guesses the ♠s correctly he will not be able to make the contract.